

LECTURE A:

Someone is a good or virtuous agent if and only if they possess (and exercise) the moral virtues.

Moral virtues are a kind of character trait—each one is dispositions of a complex sort to perform certain actions for certain reasons (or to experience certain emotions) under certain circumstances, where these traits/dispositions make their possessor good as a human being or morally admirable.

[illegible]

Are there any interesting features that the different virtues have in common?

Aristotle's "Doctrine of the Mean".

“[M]oral excellence...is concerned with passions and actions and in these there is **excess, defect, and the intermediate**. For instance, both fear and confidence and appetite and anger... may be felt both **too much, and too little**, and in both cases, not well. [...] Therefore, **excellence is a kind of mean**, since it aims at what is intermediate” (*Nicomachean Ethics*, 1106b28)

Does Aristotle say what the mean point is, or how to recognize it?

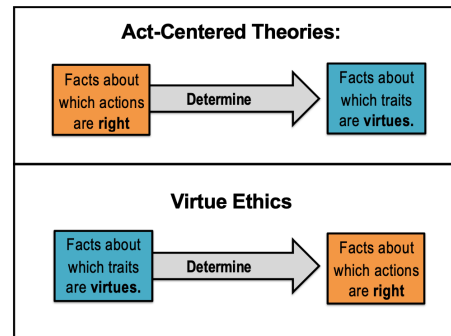
“But having these feelings at the right times, about the right things, toward the right people, for the right end, and in the right way, is the intermediate and best condition, and this is proper to virtue”
(*Nicomachean Ethics*, 1106b21)

LECTURE B:

PART II: WHAT IS DISTINCTIVE ABOUT VIRTUE ETHICS?.

A generic schema for act-centered definitions of the virtues, a generic schema:

- (1) x is a **moral virtue** if and only if x is a disposition to perform morally right act-tokens.
- (2) y is a **morally right act-token** if and only if y....



A virtue centered theory of morally right action:

VTR: An act-token, x, is morally right if and only if **a perfectly virtuous agent would perform x**, if they were in the same circumstances as the agent of x.

PART III: TWO MINOR CHALLENGES TO VIRTUE ETHICS.

Challenge 1: Conflicting Virtues.

Reply a: _____

Reply b: _____

Challenge 2: When the Agent Dug Their Own Hole.

Reply 1: _____

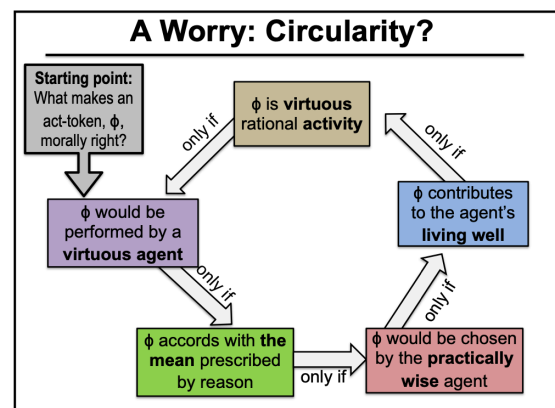
Reply 2: _____

Reply 3: _____

PART IV: THE LACK OF GUIDANCE COMPLAINT.

Aristotle's summary statement of what virtue consists in: "Excellence [Virtue], then, is a state concerned with choice, **lying in a mean** relative to us, this being **determined by reason** and in the way in which the **man of practical wisdom** would determine it" (*Nicomachean Ethics*, 1106b36).

Aristotle on what practical wisdom consists in: "Practical wisdom...must be a reasoned and true state of capacity to act with regard to human goods" (*Nicomachean Ethics*, 1140b20).



REFERENCES.

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